political rallies. These rallies were different from the usual political speeches; they included performances by Pakistani pop stars, DJs and celebrities that were there to support and entertain. The target audience were young Pakistanis, as the future of 'naya Pakistan'. Despite the close connection between the security services and the PTI, the party's rhetoric, in particular Prime Minister Imran Khan's inaugural speech, does reflect the sentiments and priorities of young people that are discussed in this book, in particular with regard to the four themes explored across the various chapters: social contract, education, terrorism and the 'right kind' of Islam.

The social contract

Prime Minister Imran Khan's speech drew on Islamic principles of justice and equality and directly addressed concerns regarding corruption, unemployment, education and basic human rights that are discussed in this book. The speech reflected the realization of the need to strengthen the state's ability to deliver basic services and maintain law and order: 'We will establish the supremacy of the law; whoever violates the law, we will act against them.' Khan promised to fix the government so that taxes would benefit the poor and state expenses would be cut. In order to repair Pakistan's fiscal deficit and resolve the economic crisis he promised to halt corruption, which he believes is at the heart of Pakistan's dysfunctional institutions: 'Our state institutions will be so strong that they will stop corruption.' This was directly addressed to the youth who have doubts about the democratic system and lack confidence in state institutions, putting their faith in the army to provide justice and security. It is the first time a Pakistani political party showed any kind of understanding that the Pakistani state in its current form is largely irrelevant in the lives of ordinary Pakistanis, having been unable to provide any economic or social security, and repeatedly accused of corruption and negligence; he also went further and promised to fix it.

Education and unemployment

Beyond governance and state responsibility, Khan addressed issues directly relevant to the youth as he did frequently during his election campaign, thereby getting the support of young voters, especially in the urban centres: 'There are countries with less than 25 million people, and we have that many children out of school.' Not offering a solution, he did link problems in education to another huge issue that Pakistan is facing – unemployment. 'Our second problem is unemployment. We have the second youngest population in the world; they